

Relay — Functional Use Cases

Test evidence for beta readiness. Every screenshot below was produced against the **production database** (Aurora DSQL, both regions) — most in the 2026-08-17 reshoot, driven by `scripts/capture-screens.ts` against the production cluster; the remainder from the 2026-08-12/13 production walks whose screens have not changed since.

Build

master @ e50a68a + the 2026-08-17 working set (secret types Phase 0, owner-set irreplaceable, backup notes). Re-derive before trusting: the commands live in `PROJECT.yaml` → `derived`.

Suite

2656 passed / 1 skipped across 240 files (2026-08-17) · typecheck, lint and build clean

Environment

Production data — Vercel, Aurora DSQL (us-east-1 / us-west-2), AWS KMS

Method

One purpose-built circle, staged through the product’s own APIs and walked

end to end in sequence

rather than screen by screen. The 2026-08-17 reshoot (`scripts/capture-screens.ts` , 16/16 assertions) built the Chen circle — a structured secret with a live TOTP seed, a claimed and confirmed recipient, a claimed and confirmed verifier, an active helper with a recorded consent — fired a real emergency, had the verifier confirm it, opened the plan, pressed Reveal, and checked back in. Each screenshot is the state the previous action produced. The four release walks (`npm run verify:live`) passed 70/70 the same day, and the claim path was additionally verified in a real browser against `relaystandby.com` itself.

Data handling

All fixtures deleted afterwards; production returned to its baseline accounts with zero orphaned rows.

Coverage summary

REF	USE CASE	ACTOR	RESULT
UC-01	Know whether the vault could actually open	Owner	Pass
UC-02	Build the circle, and see who does not count	Owner	Pass
UC-03	Decide who can reach what	Owner	Pass
UC-04	Set the conditions	Owner	Pass
UC-05	Choose someone to help set it up	Owner	Pass
UC-06	Record how consent was obtained	Owner	Pass
UC-07	Accept a place in someone's plan	Contact	Pass
UC-08	Stand by, and see the shape of the grant	Recipient	Pass
UC-09	Ask them to open it	Recipient	Pass
UC-10	Answer a request for access	Owner	Pass
UC-11	Start a release yourself	Owner	Pass
UC-12	Be told a decision is waiting	Verifier	Pass
UC-13	Answer “is this real?”	Verifier	Pass
UC-14	Hear what happened after answering	Verifier	Pass
UC-15	Open what was set aside	Recipient	Pass
UC-16	Stop it — check in and close everything	Owner	Pass

REF	USE CASE	ACTOR	RESULT
UC-17	Read what happened while you were away	Owner	Pass
UC-18	Get back in when the code never arrived	Verifier	Pass
UC-19	Get back in after losing a device	Contact	Pass
UC-20	Leave, export, or close the account	Owner	Pass
UC-21	Public surfaces and the legal pages	Visitor	Pass
UC-22	Create a vault	New owner	Pass
UC-23	Get back in after losing the authenticator	Owner	Pass
UC-24	Find out you have been made a helper	Helper	Pass
UC-25	Add things to somebody else's vault	Helper	Pass
UC-26	Suggest a person, and be unable to add them	Helper	Pass
UC-27	Answer a helper's suggestion	Owner	Pass
UC-28	Bring a password manager export in	Owner	Pass
UC-29	Be shown where to start	New owner	Pass
UC-30	Be stopped before firing a release by mistake	Owner	Pass
UC-31	Check it is really them — the verification call	Both	Pass
UC-32	Review what a helper has done on your behalf	Owner	Pass
UC-33	Know how many ways back in you have left	Owner	Pass
UC-34	Meet a page that is missing, or one that broke	Anyone	Pass
UC-35	Judge the product without an account	Visitor	Pass
UC-36	Store more than a password — and have it open usable	Owner & recipient	Pass
UC-37	Say what cannot be replaced, and leave a note	Owner	Pass

Two access paths are covered throughout. A contact who has *accepted a standby account* signs in as themselves and nothing secret is transmitted when a release opens — UC-15 was walked that way and the URL carried no token. A contact who cannot sign in — a recipient who never accepted, or a verified verifier holding no passkey and no authenticator — acts using a single-use code, which is why UC-18 and UC-19 show code entry.

UC-01 — Know whether the vault could actually open

Actor	Owner
Goal	Answer one question without reading anything: if something happened tomorrow, would this work?
Expected	A standing statement on every screen. Green only when the plan can actually run; when not, the single fastest next action, not a list of everything imperfect.

Verified

Pass. Reads “could reach all 4 of the things that matter”, naming the confirmed recipient — counting only items that matter and only people who can actually act. A non-fatal gap (“a second person who can confirm”) is stated without turning the headline red. Since 2026-08-17 the “Worth a second look” box below the vault adds custody-risk advice — see UC-37.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

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Sign out

N

If something happened tomorrow, Sarah Chen could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Vault

6 items · most consequential first

Re-order by importance

Import CSV

Add item

1 Primary email

Other accounts recover through this one

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

2 Photo archive

Family photos

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

3 Checking account

First National

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Edit note

Update

Remove

4 Utilities

City Power & Water

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

5 Streaming TV

Streaming TV · <https://streaming.test>

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

6 Pharmacy refills

Pharmacy refills · <https://pharmacy.test>

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

Next: [name who could reach these](#) — a vault nobody can open is a vault that does nothing.

Worth a second look

Nothing here is broken and nothing is blocked — these are the items where a person stepping in would have the least to go on.

CUSTODY RISK

Photo archive

— This item is irreplaceable and has no backup note — a recipient may not know where the original is kept or how to recover it.

Primary email

— No plain-language note. A recipient may not understand what this account is for or how to use it.

Utilities

— No plain-language note. A recipient may not understand what this account is for or how to use it.

Streaming TV

— No plain-language note. A recipient may not understand what this account is for or how to use it.

Pharmacy refills

— No plain-language note. A recipient may not understand what this account is for or how to use it.

UC-01 — the vault, most consequential first, under the standing statement.

UC-02 — Build the circle, and see who does not count

Actor	Owner
Goal	Name who would step in and who would confirm, and understand what is still missing.
Expected	Naming is stated as the first half of two. Each person's line says what is <i>missing</i> , not merely which state they are in. A contact the owner has marked emergency-code-only is never counted as somebody to chase.
Verified	Pass. Four person states on one screen: verified, emergency-code-only, never accepted, and a verified verifier with no fallback. The completeness box counts one outstanding person — the aunt marked code-only is correctly excluded — and no longer claims “nothing would open” while the banner above says the plan works.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

People

Who would step in, who would be asked whether an emergency is real, and what each of them could reach.

Naming someone is the first half. Once they accept, call them and check the phrase matches — until you do, their answer would not count towards opening anything.

Everyone is named — but 1 of them has not been verified yet.

Until you check it is really them, their answer would not count towards opening anything. It is a two-minute call each.

Suggested starting point

Built from what the importance engine already knows. Accept what fits.

Pat Morgan gets act access to 2 items on an emergency trigger

Root credentials are the reset path for everything else. Without them, nothing else can be recovered.

Accept

Pat Morgan gets view access to 2 items on an emergency trigger

Critical money and health accounts are what a caregiver reaches for first.

Accept

Who holds what

PERSON	ROLE	ITEMS REACHABLE
Pat Morgan	caregiver	1 / 25
Jordan Rivera	partner	4 / 25

Who would step in

The people who would receive access. Nothing opens for them until a trigger fires and the people you named confirm it is real — and a person you have not verified cannot receive anything.

Pat Morgan

caregiver

Accepted — not yet verified, so their answer would not count

pat@example.com

If Pat Morgan loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

RenameRemove

Check it is really them

Emergency code

Jordan Rivera

partner

Verified — their answer counts

jordan@example.com

If Jordan Rivera loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

RenameRemove

Verified — undo

Emergency code

Name

Email

recipient

Relationship (optional)

Phone (optional)

Add this person

Who confirms it is real

They are asked whether an emergency is real. Their answer only counts once you have checked it is really them. They never see what is inside your vault — only how much, and only when they are asked.

Sam Rivera

Verified — their answer counts

sam@example.com

No passkey — an emergency code is their only way back in. Worth checking Sam Rivera still knows where it is.

RenameRemove

Verified — undo

Emergency code

Dr. Alex Chen

Verified — their answer counts

achen@example.com

No passkey — an emergency code is their only way back in. Worth checking Dr. Alex Chen still knows where it is.

RenameRemove

Verified — undo

Emergency code

Name

Email

Phone (optional)

Add a verifier

UC-02 — every person state the product can produce, in one circle.

UC-03 — Decide who can reach what

Actor	Owner
Goal	Give one person scoped access to specific items under a specific kind of emergency.
Expected	Rules read as sentences. Reversible is the default; estate is forced irreversible and the control says so.
Verified	Pass. A rule provisions its trigger, which is why an unused trigger never appears and can never fire.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Access Rules

Grant a recipient scoped access to an item under a trigger.

Gmail → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

1Password → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Chase Bank → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Coinbase → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Passport → Pat Morgan

caregiver · view · reversible

Remove

NEW RULE

Vault item

Select an item...

▼

Recipient

Select a recipient...

▼

Trigger type

emergency

▼

Scope

view

▼

☒ Reversible

Release after

0

days

Add rule

UC-03 — access rules.

UC-04 — Set the conditions

Actor	Owner
Goal	Choose how long Relay waits, and how many people must agree.
Expected	Armed is the resting state. Plain language, no schema vocabulary, no demo controls shown to a non-demo owner.
Verified	Pass. “People who must agree first” rather than “Required confirmations (N)”; the demo simulate control is absent for a real account.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

YOUR TRIGGERS

Caregiver

ARMED

0/2 confirmations

Start this now

People who must agree first: 2

Set

Emergency

ARMED

0/1 confirmations

Start this now

People who must agree first: 1

Set

UC-04 — triggers, armed.

UC-05 — Choose someone to help set it up

Actor	Owner
Goal	Let an adult child do the typing without giving them anything they should not have.
Expected	What a helper can and can never do is stated before the button. Candidates are limited to people already named who have accepted.
Verified	Pass. Both lists render; a helper cannot open anything, decide access, touch a release, or add themselves.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Things waiting for you

Your helper can add and organise information. Anything that changes **who can reach it** waits for you.

Nothing is waiting. There is no rush and nothing expires.

Someone who helps you set this up

A helper can add and tidy your information so you do not have to do it all yourself.

A helper can:

- add and edit items in your vault
- import a list from elsewhere
- **suggest** people and access rules — which then wait for you

A helper can never:

- open or read anything in your vault
- decide who gets access — every one of those comes to you first
- start, stop or change a release
- add themselves to anything

Pat Morgan · not active yet

How did you agree to this?

This is kept as a record. It is what makes handing someone this help legitimate rather than simply convenient.

☒ We did it together, in person

You sat with them, showed them this screen, and they said yes.

☐ They signed something on paper

A signed note or form. Say where it is kept, so it can be found later.

☐ They confirmed it themselves, on a device

Only if they genuinely used it. If you clicked for them, say so above instead.

Where is the record kept? (optional)

e.g. signed form in the blue folder

Record it and start

Not now

[Stop them helping](#)

People you could ask

Only people you have already named, who have accepted. If someone is missing, add them to your circle first.

Dr. Alex Chen · achen@example.com

Ask them to help

Jordan Rivera · jordan@example.com

Ask them to help

Sam Rivera · sam@example.com

Ask them to help

UC-06 — Record how consent was obtained

Actor	Owner
Goal	Make the delegation legitimate rather than merely convenient.
Expected	Nothing activates until consent is recorded (J3-R2). In-person and paper are offered as <i>peers</i> of the link, because the person being delegated for is the least likely to own a smartphone (J3-R3).
Verified	Pass. Created pending → recorded in person with an evidence note → active. The link option is worded to discourage an owner recording a consent the other person never gave. Since 2026-08-17 the record is also read back: the helper's card shows how the agreement was made and the note kept ("You did it together, in person — Record kept: ...") beside the control that stops them — the evidence next to the decision it informs. Before that the consent was written and displayed by nothing.

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Sign out

If something happened tomorrow, Sarah Chen could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Things waiting for you

Your helper can add and organise information. Anything that changes **who can reach it** waits for you.

Nothing is waiting. There is no rush and nothing expires.

Someone who helps you set this up

A helper can add and tidy your information so you do not have to do it all yourself.

A helper can:

- add and edit items in your vault
- import a list from elsewhere
- suggest** people and access rules — which then wait for you

A helper can never:

- open or read anything in your vault
- decide who gets access — every one of those comes to you first
- start, stop or change a release
- add themselves to anything

Sarah Chen · helping you now

What they have done

Nothing yet.

How you agreed

You did it together, in person. — 8/17/2026

Record kept: Agreed at her kitchen table, Sunday afternoon

[Stop them helping](#)

People you could ask

Only people you have already named, who have accepted. If someone is missing, add them to your circle first.

Dr Patel · relay-shoot-patel-1787033097359@relay.test

Ask them to help

UC-06 — active only after the record exists, and the record is visible beside “Stop them helping”.

UC-07 — Accept a place in someone's plan

Actor	Named contact
Goal	Be recognisable later, without being handed anything now.
Expected	A typed code, never a link that signs you in. Accepting opens nothing.
Verified	Pass. Copy no longer assumes the code arrived by email — delivery is owner-brokered by design. Hardened 2026-08-17: the page now fires the claim exactly once (an effect re-run cannot double-spend the single-use code) and confirms a session actually exists before moving on — NextAuth reports a CSRF-refused claim as success, and the only thing that can tell a minted session from a refused one is the session endpoint. On a transient failure the code is unspent and the offered retry genuinely works. The claim path itself was re-verified in a real browser against relaystandby.com: code redeemed, session minted, standby dashboard resolved.

Enter your invitation code

Someone has named you in their Relay plan.
Type the code they gave you – they may have
read it out, texted it, or written it down.

Invitation code

4KMPQ - 7XR2W

Continue

Nothing is being opened. Accepting only tells
them you have seen it.

Not sure about any of this? [Read the common questions](#) or
ask us.



UC-08 — Stand by, and see the shape of the grant

Actor	Recipient (standby)
Goal	Know who you are standing by for and roughly what is set aside — never what it is.
Expected	The owner by name . Counts and categories only (J4-R10). Leaving always available.
Verified	Pass. "Margaret Chen", not an email address; "Set aside for you: 3 items" with categories and no titles.

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.



Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Set aside for you: 4 items — 1 communication, 2 finance, 1 personal. You cannot see what they are, and neither can we.

Nothing open.

[Ask Margaret Chen to open it](#)

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere — nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

[Set this up](#)

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

[Start your own plan](#)

Not sure about any of this? [Read the common questions](#) or ask us.

UC-09 — Ask them to open it

Actor	Recipient (standby)
Goal	Raise a request when something has happened and no trigger has fired.
Expected	The owner is asked first. Everyone else named is told a request was made, whatever the outcome (J6-R9) — and that is stated <i>before</i> the form, not discovered after. Capped at three in twenty-four hours.
Verified	Pass. Request created against production and reached the owner. Free text is capped, flattened to one line, and any link is removed before it is emailed.

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Set aside for you: 4 items – 1 communication, 2 finance, 1 personal. You cannot see what they are, and neither can we.

Nothing open.

Margaret Chen will be asked first.

Everyone else they named is told that you asked, whatever the outcome – that is deliberate, so nobody can quietly reach into someone else's accounts.

What has happened?

An emergency

In your own words

Whoever reads this may have to decide without being able to ask you anything, so say where they are and

what you need.

Ask them

Not now

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

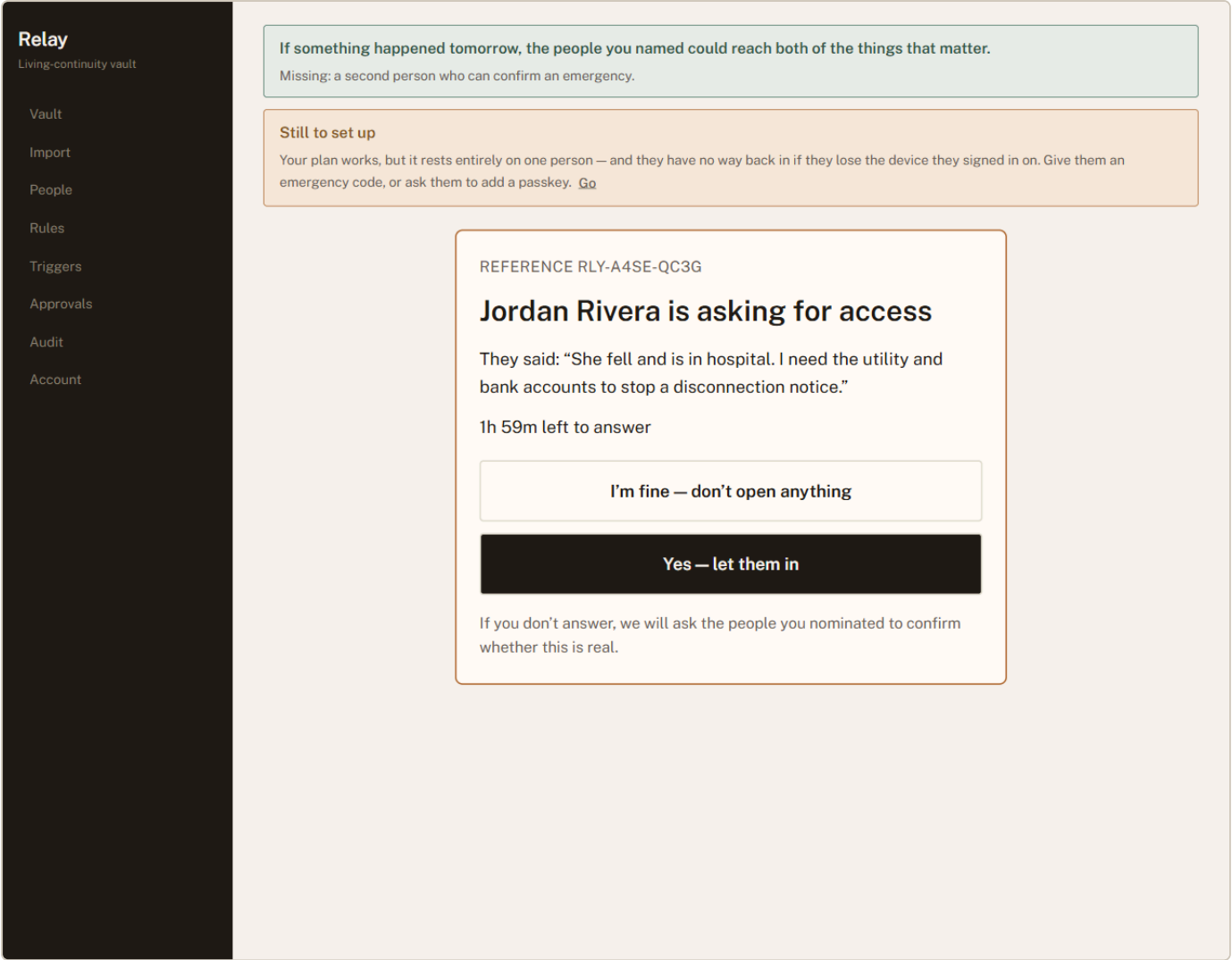
Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

UC-10 — Answer a request for access

Actor	Owner
Goal	Say “I’m fine” or “let them in” before anyone else is involved.
Expected	Who asked, in their own words, with a countdown, and a plain statement of what happens if the owner does not answer.
Verified	Pass. “Jordan Rivera is asking for access”, the reason quoted, “1h 58m left to answer”, and both answers offered.



UC-10 — the challenge. Before this walkthrough nothing in the product could produce a request for this screen to show.

UC-11 — Start a release yourself

Actor	Owner
Goal	Open the window deliberately — “I know I am about to be unreachable.”
Expected	Still requires the named people to confirm. Both reversal controls appear, and they are deliberately not equal in weight.
Verified	Pass. Advanced to the confirmable window at 0 of 1 confirmations — nothing opened. Stand down — re-arm is prominent; Cancel permanently is separated and confirms first, so somebody stopping a false alarm at speed cannot retire their whole plan by mistake.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

YOUR TRIGGERS

Caregiver

ARMED

0/2 confirmations

Start this now

People who must agree first:

2

Set

Emergency

GRACE

0/1 confirmations

Stand down — re-arm

Cancel permanently

People who must agree first:

1

Set

UC-11 / UC-16 — a release in flight, with both ways to stop it.

UC-12 — Be told a decision is waiting

Actor	Verifier (standby)
Goal	Find the question by visiting the site, with nothing to intercept.
Expected	A verifier who can sign in receives no credential at all — the message tells them to sign in, and the dashboard carries the ask.
Verified	Pass. “They need your answer” with a direct action, and no code was minted for this person.

You are on standby

Something needs your attention below.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is claimed, you will be asked one question: is this real? You will never see anything inside their vault – not now, and not after you answer.

They need your answer

Answer now

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

UC-13 — Answer “is this real?”

Actor	Verifier
Goal	Attest that an emergency is genuine, without an account created at decision time and without seeing the vault.
Expected	J7-R3 in order: who is asking, why now , what has been tried, what confirming will and will not cause. Three answers at equal prominence (J7-R6). Scale shown; contents never.
Verified	Pass. “Is this real, for Margaret Chen?” — the vault is named, which it was not before 2026-08-12. “They started this themselves” is derived from how the release began. All three answers now share one visual treatment; until this pass “Yes” was a filled button and “No” an outline.

REFERENCE RLY-TW98-VEMX

Is this real, for Margaret Chen?

An emergency release has been started on **Margaret Chen**'s vault, and you are one of the people they chose to ask.

They started this themselves, before becoming unreachable.

What has happened so far

Relay began asking the people they chose — 8/12/2026, 9:50:11 PM

Relay began asking the people they chose — 8/12/2026, 9:51:36 PM

Relay began asking the people they chose — 8/12/2026, 9:55:57 PM

If you confirm

They get access to **4** items across communication, finance, personal.

This can be undone. If it turns out to be a false alarm, access closes again.

0 of 1 needed so far.

What this does not do

You will never see any of their information. Not now, and not after you confirm. You are being asked one question only: whether the situation is genuine.

Yes — this is real

No — this is not right

I don't know

"I don't know" is a real answer. We will ask someone else rather than counting it either way.

UC-14 — Hear what happened after answering

Actor	Verifier
Goal	Not be left wondering. A verifier who hears nothing back stops answering (J7-R12).
Expected	Immediate closure naming whether it can be reversed, plus the case reference.
Verified	Pass. "Recorded. They can reverse this at any time."

Thank you

Recorded. They can reverse this at any time.

Reference RLY-8J8S-S8T9

UC-15 — Open what was set aside

Actor	Recipient
Goal	Reach the accounts that were assigned, in a usable order.
Expected	Ordered by consequence. Decryption happens in the browser. A contact who accepted signs in as themselves — no token in the URL .
Verified	Pass. Opened from a session with a clean URL; items in priority order, each revealed only on request. The plan opens behind an acknowledgment — “what this is, and what it is not”, including what to do if the owner has died — accepted before any item is shown. Reveal itself is evidenced separately in UC-36: since secret types Phase 0 it renders labelled fields, not a wall of text.

What this is, and what it is not

Margaret Chen chose to share these items with you, and set the conditions that opened them. That is all this is.

Relay does not give you legal authority. It does not make you an executor, an agent, or a representative, and the companies behind these accounts have agreed to nothing. Using someone else's credentials may breach the terms of that account whatever your reason — that is between you and them.

If Margaret Chen has died, the person with authority is their executor or personal representative. Speak to them before you use anything here.

I understand – show me the plan

Not sure about any of this? [Read the common questions](#) or ask us.



Your access plan

Margaret Chen chose to share these with you. Relay gives you access, not legal authority.

Work top to bottom – the most consequential items come first.

DO TODAY

1 Primary email [view](#)
Fastmail

[Reveal](#)

2 Photo archive [view](#)
Family photos

[Reveal](#)

3 Checking account [view](#)
First National

[Reveal](#)

The paper statements are in the fire safe – Sarah knows the code.

THIS WEEK

4 Utilities [view](#)
City Power & Water

[Reveal](#)

N

Not sure about any of this? [Read the common questions](#) or

UC-16 — Stop it: check in and close everything

Actor	Owner
Goal	Come back and have it all shut, without undoing anything by hand.
Expected	One action reverses pending, grace and released alike, and names what it closed.
Verified	Pass. "Checked in — emergency re-armed." The released trigger returned to armed and the recipient's access closed.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

Checked in — emergency re-armed.

YOUR TRIGGERS

Emergency

ARMED

0/1 confirmations

Initiate

People who must agree first:

1

Set

UC-16 — reversal, in one action.

UC-17 — Read what happened while you were away

Actor	Owner
Goal	Find out what actually happened, and be able to check that the answer is trustworthy.
Expected	The story in sentences, above a hash-chained record that cannot be edited. People named, not UUIDs. It must distinguish “somebody looked” from “nothing happened”.
Verified	Pass. “an emergency was raised and Dr. Alex Chen confirmed it was real”; the table names Dr. Alex Chen and Jordan Rivera with the raw ids beneath, and the chain still verifies — names are resolved for display only and never written into the record.

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

What happened

17 entries · append-only, hash-chained.

Server: **intact** Client: — **Verify chain**

On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised and nobody confirmed it. Nothing was opened, and it is closed again.

Closed 8/12/2026, 9:51:51 PM — because you checked back in. Nothing else was reachable, and nothing stayed open.

On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised and nobody confirmed it. Nothing was opened, and it is closed again.

Closed 8/12/2026, 9:50:36 PM — because you checked back in. Nothing else was reachable, and nothing stayed open.

On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised and nobody confirmed it. Nothing was opened, and it is closed again.

Closed 8/12/2026, 9:44:41 PM — because you checked back in. Nothing else was reachable, and nothing stayed open.

Every entry

The full record, in the order it happened. Nothing here can be edited or removed — that is what makes the summary above trustworthy rather than merely reassuring.

SEQ	TIME	ACTOR	ACTION	ENTITY	DETAIL	HASH
0	8/12/2026, 9:41:21 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	break_glass_issued	verifier · 33f971f5	▶ view	172f43a59b89...
1	8/12/2026, 9:41:22 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	break_glass_issued	verifier · 1b8807c7	▶ view	9f6de42dacbc...
2	8/12/2026, 9:44:18 PM	system	release_transition_pending	release_state · e345f931	▶ view	6155b8d88cc2...
3	8/12/2026, 9:44:19 PM	system	release_transition_grace	release_state · e345f931	▶ view	054d700e86a4...
4	8/12/2026, 9:44:19 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_initiated	release_state · e345f931	▶ view	6bb52816d3ed...
5	8/12/2026, 9:44:41 PM	system	release_transition_armed	release_state · e345f931	▶ view	12743577410a...
6	8/12/2026, 9:44:41 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	owner_checkin	release_state	▶ view	1d0403c7190f...
7	8/12/2026, 9:50:11 PM	system	release_transition_pending	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	038d1805ec3e...
8	8/12/2026, 9:50:11 PM	system	release_transition_grace	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	bec38a27d189...
9	8/12/2026, 9:50:11 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_initiated	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	509ca50d37bb...
10	8/12/2026, 9:50:36 PM	system	release_transition_armed	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	341fce6dc3ef...
11	8/12/2026, 9:50:36 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_stood_down	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	00dbfe0d771e...
12	8/12/2026, 9:51:36 PM	system	release_transition_pending	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	4ac7de4f3021...
13	8/12/2026, 9:51:36 PM	system	release_transition_grace	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	d8a1d3ad5419...
14	8/12/2026, 9:51:36 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_initiated	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	1d65f1092988...
15	8/12/2026, 9:51:51 PM	system	release_transition_armed	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	31139ca29a5c...
16	8/12/2026, 9:51:51 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_stood_down	release_state · ef3c990a	▶ view	5c2cae37b273...

UC-18 — Get back in when the code never arrived

Actor	Verifier
Goal	Answer even though the message never arrived or the code expired.
Expected	Self-service, because the owner may be the person in hospital. Sends to the address on file, never to one typed in.
Verified	Pass. "My code has expired, or never arrived" opens the form. What is sent depends on how the person is set up, so the wording promises what they need rather than "a code". Since 2026-08-17 the error state is no longer a dead end: a bad code returns to the code form to try again, and a decision submit that fails on a network hiccup returns to the decision screen with the decision intact — the crueller case, because they had already answered. A structural guard (emergency-paths-have-a-way-back) covers both emergency surfaces so the next dead end cannot be fixed on one alone.

Enter your code

Someone has asked you to confirm that a situation is genuine. Type the code we sent you.

Code from your email

7 K 4 M - P 2 X W

Continue

[My code has expired, or never arrived](#)

You will never be shown anyone's private information — not now, and not after you answer. Relay will never send you a link that signs you in.

UC-19 — Get back in after losing a device

Actor	Any contact
Goal	Act when the usual sign-in is gone — or when there never was one.
Expected	Works once. The owner is told it was used and asked to check it was really them.
Verified	Pass. Copy now names the real alternative when the owner cannot be reached: the others they named can still answer.

Use your emergency code

If you were given a code to keep somewhere safe, type it here. It is the way back in when your usual sign-in is not available.

It works once. The person who gave it to you will be told that you used it, and they will be asked to check it was really you — that is deliberate, and it is what makes a code like this safe to carry.

Your emergency code

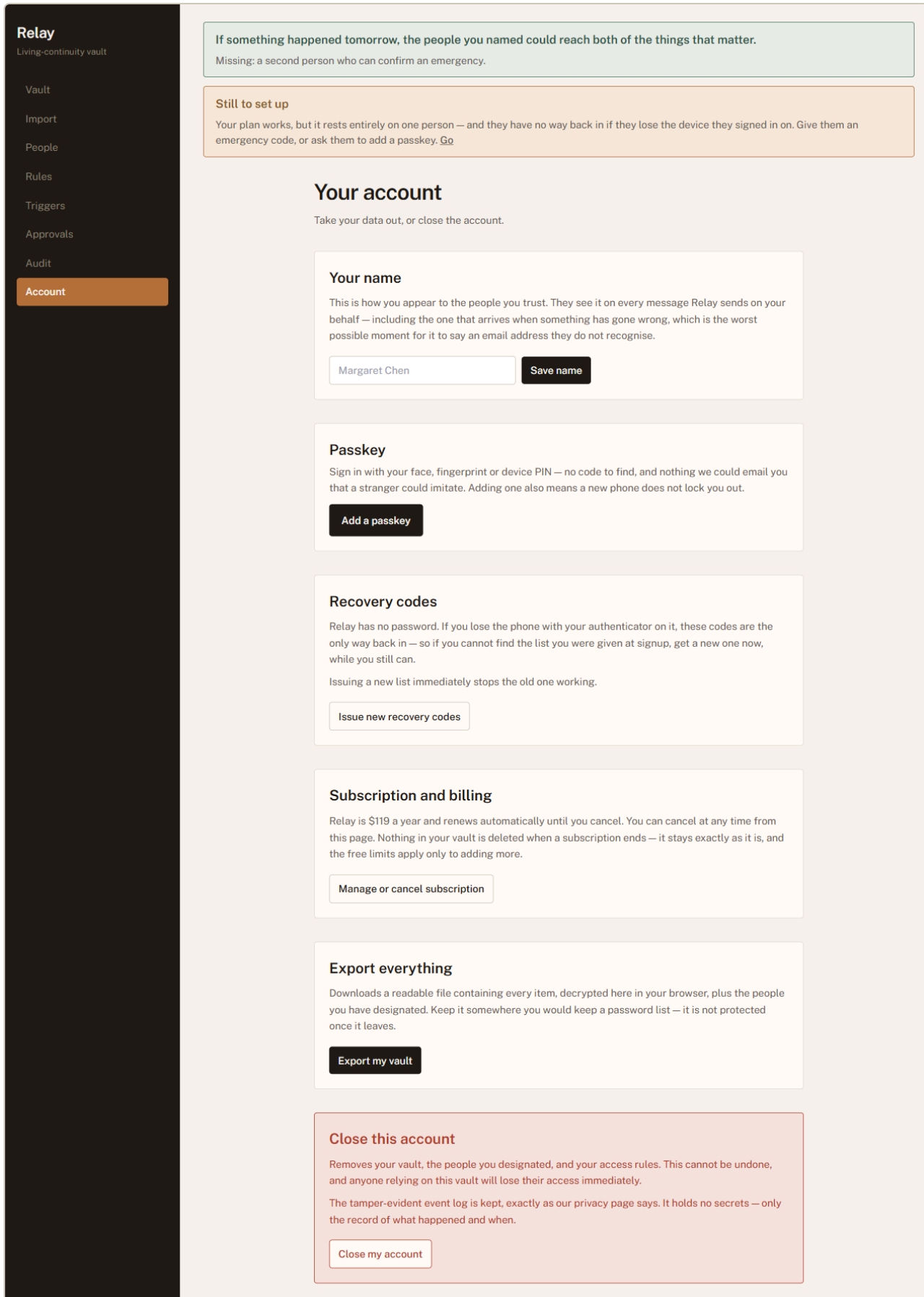
XXXX - XXXX - XXXX

Continue

No code? Ask the person who named you, if you can reach them — they can issue a new one. Relay cannot send you one directly, because a code that arrives in an email is a code anyone who reaches that inbox could use. If you cannot reach them, that is what the others they named are for: a decision does not wait on any one person, and the rest of their circle can still answer without you.

UC-20 — Leave, export, or close the account

Actor	Owner
Goal	Take the data out, stop paying, or leave entirely.
Expected	Export decrypted in the browser; cancel without losing the vault; close with the consequences stated in the one colour reserved for what cannot be undone.
Verified	Pass. Name, passkey, recovery codes, subscription, export and closure all present. Leaving is a first-class path, not a support ticket.



UC-20 — the account screen.

UC-21 — Public surfaces and the legal pages

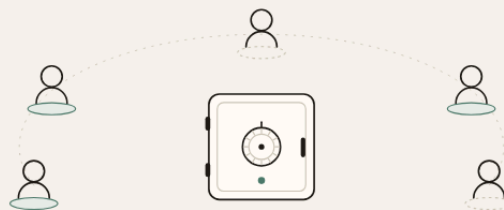
Actor	Visitor, and people who never signed up
Goal	Understand the product, and — if somebody named you — find out what that means for you.
Expected	Terms and Privacy each address the population that did not sign up and was merely named.
Verified	Pass. Both live, both carrying those sections. Since 2026-08-16 the operator is named: <code>/about</code> exists, and the landing, terms and privacy pages say who runs Relay and how to reach a person. Fixed 2026-08-17: the site-wide link-preview metadata still offered “permanent estate handoff” — a capability withdrawn 2026-08-14 and disclaimed by <code>/terms</code> ; the share image and <code>/caregivers</code> had each been scrubbed, and the inherited <code><head></code> description was the third door. A guard now reads the served literal. Counsel review was declined under <code>g2-counsel-opinion</code> ; these pages do not substitute for legal advice and say so.

The accounts someone would need, if you could not manage them.

Relay holds them encrypted, opens only what you chose for the person you chose, and only once a real emergency has been confirmed by someone you trust — then closes again when you recover. One price for the whole family, \$119 a year.

[I'm caring for a parent](#)

[Show me what actually happens](#)



N



It closes again

Every other way of doing this is a door you open once. Recover, check in, and access ends on its own — which is what makes it safe to set up before you need it.



We cannot read it

Secrets are encrypted in your browser before they reach us. We hold ciphertext, and we are honest on exactly what we can see.



Someone has to say yes

Nothing opens on a timer or a guess. A person you named confirms the situation is real, and never sees anything of yours.

Were you named by someone?

If someone has asked you to be a recipient or a trusted contact, you will have an email with a code in it. Enter it at relaystandby.com/claim. A real message from Relay never asks you to click a link and then enter anything — if a message claiming to be from us does, it is not from us.

Who is behind Relay

Relay asks you to trust it with the accounts that matter most to your family. You should know who is asking.

One person, named

Relay is built and operated by **Steve Harlow**. Not a company — an individual. There is no team behind the word “we”, so this page does not use it.

That is worth being plain about rather than dressing up. Independent software has real limits, and they are set out in the [Terms](#) and on the [security page](#), including the honest answer to what happens to your vault if Relay stops existing.

[Steve on LinkedIn](#)

Why it exists

Most families handle this the only way they know how: one person keeps everything, and if that person is suddenly unreachable, nobody else can get in. The usual fix is to share the passwords — which works right up until it doesn't, and cannot be undone.

Relay exists because the reverse should be possible: access that opens only when people you trust confirm something real has happened, gives out only what you chose in advance, and **seals itself again when you check back in**. Setting it up should not require deciding to give anything away permanently.

Reaching a human

hello@relaystandby.com reaches Steve directly. It is read by a person, not a queue, and it is the right address for support, security reports, refunds and press.

Writing about family caregiving or digital access and want to ask something? Same address.



UC-22 — Create a vault

Actor	New owner
Goal	Start, without inventing a password.
Expected	Two steps, an authenticator required, and recovery codes issued at the point they can still be saved.
Verified	Pass. The name field shows a live preview of the consequence of leaving it blank — “they will see <i>your email address</i> when we contact them” — which is the same defect that had to be fixed in the standby dashboard, pre-empted at the one moment it can be avoided.

Relay

Create your vault

Two steps. An authenticator app is required — there is no password.

Email address

Your name (optional)

This is how you appear to the people you trust — they will see “your email address” when we contact them.

Continue

Already have an account? [Sign in](#)

UC-23 — Get back in after losing the authenticator

Actor	Owner
Goal	Recover a vault when the phone with the authenticator is gone.
Expected	A recovery code replaces how you sign in and touches nothing inside the vault — and the page says so, because the fear at that moment is that the data is gone.
Verified	Pass. “Your vault contents are untouched — this only replaces how you sign in.”

Get back in

Lost the phone with your authenticator? Use one of the recovery codes you saved when you created your vault. Your vault contents are untouched — this only replaces how you sign in.

Email address

One recovery code

Continue

[Back to sign in](#)

UC-24 — Find out you have been made a helper

Actor	Helper
Goal	Discover the job exists at all.
Expected	Told on a screen they already visit, with the boundary summarised before they go any further.
Verified	Pass. "You are helping Margaret Chen set up" on the standby dashboard. Until this pass nothing told them — an owner could appoint somebody and the person on the other end had no screen, no message and no route they could have guessed.

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Nothing open.

[Ask Margaret Chen to open it](#)

[Step down from this](#)

You are helping Margaret Chen set up

You can add things to their vault and suggest people. You cannot open anything, and anything that decides who can reach what goes to them as a question.

[Open their setup](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

[Set this up](#)

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

[Start your own plan](#)

UC-25 — Add things to somebody else's vault

Actor	Helper
Goal	Do the typing an older parent will not do, without gaining anything they should not have.
Expected	Encrypted in the helper's browser exactly as an owner's is. Sealed on save — a helper cannot read back even their own entry (J3-R4). The boundary is stated above the tools, not discovered by trying.
Verified	Pass. Item saved to another person's vault with delegate provenance recorded and the audit entry attributed to <code>delegate:<id></code> . Probed from the helper's own session: their list returns only their entry — the owner's private item is absent — carries no ciphertext, and a vault with no delegation returns 403 .

Helping Margaret Chen

You can add things to Margaret Chen's vault, and suggest people. Anything that decides **who can reach what** goes to Margaret Chen as a question – you cannot make that call for them.

You cannot open or read anything in their vault – including the things you type here. Once an entry is saved it is sealed to them, so check it before you save it. That is deliberate: it is what makes it safe for them to accept help.

Add something

What is it?

e.g. Electricity account

Kind

login



Category

finance



The details they would need

Account number, sign-in, where the paperwork is – whatever would actually help. This is encrypted before it leaves this page, and you will not be able to read it back.

Saved. It is sealed to them now.

Save to their vault

What you have added

Electricity account · login · finance

Suggest someone who would step in

This does not add them. It goes to Margaret Chen as a question, and only they can say yes.

Their name

Their email

How would you describe them?

recipient



☐ This is me.

Perfectly reasonable to ask – and Margaret Chen will be told clearly that the person suggesting it is the person it is about.

Suggest to Margaret Chen

UC-26 — Suggest a person, and be unable to add them

Actor	Helper
Goal	Say "my brother should be on this" without being able to make it so.
Expected	Everything that decides who can reach what stops and waits for the owner (J3-R6). A helper proposing themselves is offered plainly and labelled on the way past, because hiding it would only mean somebody typing their own name in the field above and nobody noticing.
Verified	Pass. Proposal queued against the helped vault, shown back as "waiting for Margaret Chen", and nothing changed in the circle until she answered.

Helping Margaret Chen

You can add things to Margaret Chen's vault, and suggest people. Anything that decides **who can reach what** goes to Margaret Chen as a question — you cannot make that call for them.

You cannot open or read anything in their vault — including the things you type here. Once an entry is saved it is sealed to them, so check it before you save it. That is deliberate: it is what makes it safe for them to accept help.

Add something

What is it?

e.g. Electricity account

Kind

login



Category

finance



The details they would need

Account number, sign-in, where the paperwork is — whatever would actually help. This is encrypted before it leaves this page, and you will not be able to read it back.

Saved. It is sealed to them now.

Save to their vault

What you have added

Electricity account · login · finance

Suggest someone who would step in

This does not add them. It goes to Margaret Chen as a question, and only they can say yes.

Sent. It is waiting for Margaret Chen to answer.

Their name

Their email

How would you describe them?

recipient



☐ This is me.

Perfectly reasonable to ask — and Margaret Chen will be told clearly that the person suggesting it is the person it is about.

Suggest to Margaret Chen

Waiting for Margaret Chen

Sam Rivera — suggested as someone who would step in

UC-27 — Answer a helper's suggestion

Actor	Owner
Goal	Decide, in plain language, on something somebody proposed on your behalf.
Expected	Approving runs through the same validated path an owner would use — an approved proposal is not a trusted insert.
Verified	Pass. The queue showed the suggestion, the owner approved, and Sam Rivera appeared in the circle as a real recipient. This screen had rendered an empty state since it shipped , waiting on a proposal nothing in the product could make.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

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Account

If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach none of the 1 things that matter.

Missing: Electricity account and nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

Still to set up

No access rules yet, so nothing would be shared even in an emergency. [Go](#)

Things waiting for you

Your helper can add and organise information. Anything that changes **who can reach it** waits for you.

Your helper suggests adding Sam Rivera as a recipient.

Yes, that's fine

No, not this

Saying no changes nothing else. You can decide later.

Someone who helps you set this up

A helper can add and tidy your information so you do not have to do it all yourself.

A helper can:

- add and edit items in your vault
- import a list from elsewhere
- **suggest** people and access rules — which then wait for you

A helper can never:

- open or read anything in your vault
- decide who gets access — every one of those comes to you first
- start, stop or change a release
- add themselves to anything

Jordan Rivera · helping you now

[Stop them helping](#)

UC-27 — the queue, filled for the first time.

UC-28 — Bring a password manager export in

Actor	Owner
Goal	Start from what already exists rather than typing it all again.
Expected	Parsed and encrypted entirely in the browser . A preview before anything is written, and the importance engine re-run afterwards so nothing lands silently uncovered.
Verified	Pass. A LastPass export previewed and imported against the production cluster; every row appeared in the vault. The preview shows service, URL and username and no passwords — the one screen where a shoulder-surfer would see the whole file at once. Since 2026-08-17 duplicates are explained, not just skipped: re-importing the same file reports “Imported 0 items, and left 2 already in your vault untouched — including any two-factor codes in this export” and says how to add a code to an item that already exists, so an owner who counted rows is not left believing items went missing. The import also carries the second factor: a TOTP column is preserved rather than silently dropped, and each imported item is stored as labelled fields.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

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Approvals

Audit

Account

Help

Sign out

N

If something happened tomorrow, Sarah Chen could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Import

Import a CSV export. It is parsed and encrypted entirely in your browser.

CSV file

Format

Choose File

lastpass-export.csv

lastpass

Preview

2 items to import

Encrypt & import 2

SERVICE	URL	USERNAME	2FA
Streaming TV	https://streaming.test	margaret.c	—
Pharmacy refills	https://pharmacy.test	mchen1952	—

Imported 0 items, and left 2 already in your vault untouched.

The 2 already in your vault were left alone — **including any two-factor codes in this export**. To add a code to an account you already have, open it in your vault and choose Update.

UC-28 — a repeat import: nothing lost, and the untouched duplicates named.

UC-29 — Be shown where to start

Actor	New owner
Goal	Not face an empty vault and a blank mind.
Expected	The question that produces a useful list — not “add an item”.
Verified	Pass. “If they were hospitalised tomorrow, these are the accounts you would need first.”

Relay

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If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

This vault would not open in an emergency.

No trusted contact yet. Without one, an emergency can start but can never be confirmed — your vault would not open. [Fix this](#)

Start with what you'd need first

If they were hospitalised tomorrow, these are the accounts you would reach for.

Step 1 of 8

0 saved

Their primary email

The address most other accounts reset through

Which one? (optional)

Gmail, Chase, Blue Cross...

Login details or a note

Encrypted in your browser before it is sent

☒ Other accounts reset through this one

Save and continue

Skip

UC-29 — the first-run prompt.

UC-30 — Be stopped before firing a release by mistake

Actor	Owner
Goal	Not start an emergency with one stray click on a button labelled with a word that does not say what it does.
Expected	The consequence stated, not “are you sure”. Reversible and irreversible triggers get different sentences and different weights; the irreversible one asks the trigger type to be typed , matching what closing an account already demands.
Verified	Pass. “Everyone you named to confirm an emergency will be asked whether this is real... You can stop it at any point by checking in.” Backing out left the trigger ARMED and changed nothing. II This is a precondition on g2-counsel-opinion , not an improvement — today every selectable trigger is reversible, and the day estate becomes selectable that click is permanent. Since the grace ruling of the same day the estate branch also states the three-day window that follows: with no way to reverse a completed handover, that window is the only chance anyone gets to stop it.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

YOUR TRIGGERS

Caregiver

ARMED

0/2 confirmations

Start this now

People who must agree first: 2

Set

Emergency

ARMED

0/1 confirmations

Everyone you named to confirm an emergency will be asked whether this is real. If enough of them agree, the access you arranged opens. You can stop it at any point by checking in.

Yes — ask them now

Not yet

People who must agree first: 1

Set

UC-30 — the confirmation.

UC-31 — Check it is really them

Actor	Owner and contact, together, on the phone
Goal	Establish that the person who accepted the invitation is the person who was meant to.
Expected	Four words derived from the binding, shown to both sides. The owner reads theirs aloud; the contact confirms theirs match. A mismatch means somebody else opened the invitation, and both screens say what to do about it.
Verified	Pass. Both screens read <code>granite forest mitten granite</code> . The owner pressed “The words matched”, the person flipped to verified, and readiness moved from “ <i>your plan cannot run yet</i> ” to executable.

This is the most consequential use case in the product, and until 2026-08-12 it could not be performed at all. The owner’s screen has always said “They see the same four words on their own screen” — and nothing showed them to the contact. The owner was being asked to make a *comparison the other side could not take part in*, and a person asked “do these match?” while holding nothing says yes. Everything downstream rests on it: since §4.3, only a **confirmed** person’s answer counts towards opening anything.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

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If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Your plan cannot run yet

Confirm a recipient who has already claimed. Verifiers could agree, but nobody is set up to receive anything. [Go to your circle](#)

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

People

Who would step in, who would be asked whether an emergency is real, and what each of them could reach.

Naming someone is the first half. Once they accept, call them and check the phrase matches — until you do, their answer would not count towards opening anything.

Everyone is named — but 1 of them has not been verified yet.

Until you check it is really them, their answer would not count towards opening anything. It is a two-minute call each.

Suggested starting point

Built from what the importance engine already knows. Accept what fits.

Jordan Rivera gets act access to 1 item on an emergency trigger

Root credentials are the reset path for everything else. Without them, nothing else can be recovered.

Accept

Who holds what

PERSON	ROLE	ITEMS REACHABLE
Jordan Rivera	partner	1 / 1

Who would step in

The people who would receive access. Nothing opens for them until a trigger fires and the people you named confirm it is real — and a person you have not verified cannot receive anything.

Jordan Rivera partner ● Accepted — not yet verified, so their answer would not count

ra-jordan@relay.invalid

If Jordan Rivera loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Call Jordan Rivera and read this out

granite forest mitten granite

Remove

They see the same four words on their own screen. Speaking to them is the point — it is the one channel nobody else can reach, and it is what tells you the person who accepted is the person you meant.

The words matched

They did not match

Not now

[Emergency code](#)

recipient

Add this person

Who confirms it is real

They are asked whether an emergency is real. Their answer only counts once you have checked it is really them. They never see what is inside your vault — only how much, and only when they are asked.

Dr. Alex Chen ● Verified — their answer counts

ra-chen@relay.invalid

If Dr. Alex Chen loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Remove

[Verified — undo](#)

[Emergency code](#)

Add a verifier

UC-31 — the owner’s side: call them and read this out.

RELAY

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Margaret Chen will call you and read out four words. These are yours — they should be the same.

**granite forest mitten
granite**

If they do not match, say so and stop — it means somebody else opened the invitation meant for you. Nothing is lost; they can start again on a channel you both trust.

Set aside for you: 1 item — 1 communication. You cannot see what they are, and neither can we.

Nothing open.

Ask Margaret Chen to open it

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere — nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

UC-31 — the contact's side, which did not exist before, including what to do when the words do **not** match.

UC-32 — Review what a helper has done on your behalf

Actor	Owner
Goal	Know what somebody with setup rights actually did, without reading a raw log.
Expected	J3-R8. Plain language, derived from the audit chain rather than a second log that could drift from it, and placed beside the control that removes them — the evidence belongs next to the decision it informs.
Verified	Pass. A helper added an item and suggested a person; the owner saw “Added something to your vault” and “Suggested somebody who would step in”. In the record itself the actor now reads “Jordan Rivera (helping you)” with the raw id beneath and the chain still intact — delegates were the one actor type without a name until this pass.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

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Help

Sign out

If something happened tomorrow, Sarah Chen could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Things waiting for you

Your helper can add and organise information. Anything that changes **who can reach it** waits for you.

Nothing is waiting. There is no rush and nothing expires.

Someone who helps you set this up

A helper can add and tidy your information so you do not have to do it all yourself.

A helper can:

- add and edit items in your vault
- import a list from elsewhere
- suggest** people and access rules — which then wait for you

A helper can never:

- open or read anything in your vault
- decide who gets access — every one of those comes to you first
- start, stop or change a release
- add themselves to anything

Sarah Chen · helping you now

What they have done

Nothing yet.

How you agreed

You did it together, in person. — 8/17/2026

Record kept: Agreed at her kitchen table, Sunday afternoon

[Stop them helping](#)

People you could ask

Only people you have already named, who have accepted. If someone is missing, add them to your circle first.

Dr Patel · relay-shoot-patel-1787033097359@relay.test

Ask them to help

UC-32 — what they did, beside “Stop them helping”.

Relay

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If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach none of the 1 things that matter.

Missing: Water rates and nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

Still to set up

No access rules yet, so nothing would be shared even in an emergency. [Go](#)

What happened

2 entries · append-only, hash-chained.

Server: intact Client: — Verify chain

Nothing has ever been opened.

No emergency has been raised on your vault. If one ever is, what happened will be written here in plain words — who confirmed it, what was opened, and when it closed again.

Every entry

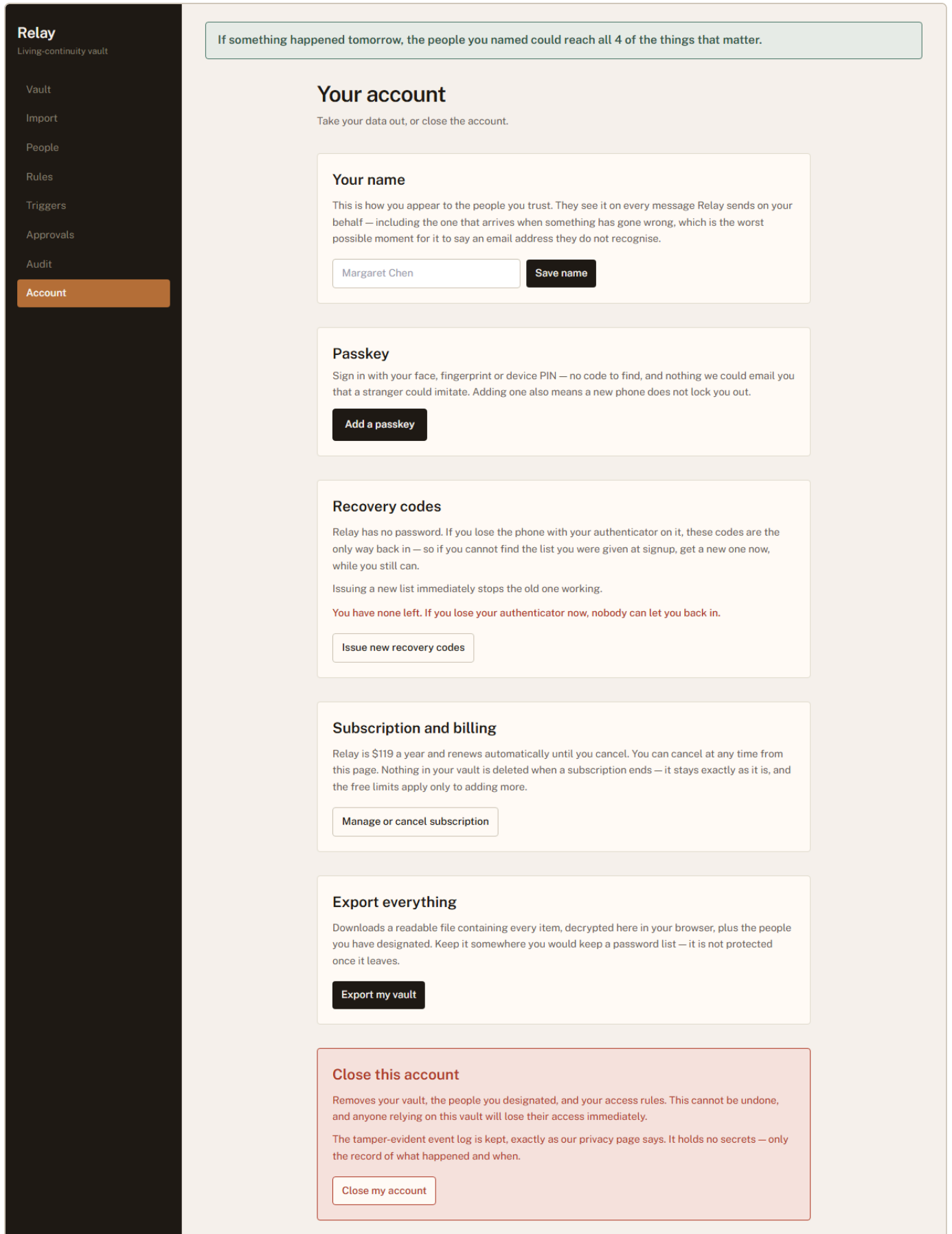
The full record, in the order it happened. Nothing here can be edited or removed — that is what makes the summary above trustworthy rather than merely reassuring.

SEQ	TIME	ACTOR	ACTION	ENTITY	DETAIL	HASH
0	8/12/2026, 8:36:34 PM	Jordan Rivera (helping you) delegate:62f57701-393b-4eee-8a85-423d0fbb394b	vault_item_created	vault_item · d91e3771	▶ view	1fc012b51e12...
1	8/12/2026, 8:36:41 PM	Jordan Rivera (helping you) delegate:62f57701-393b-4eee-8a85-423d0fbb394b	approval_requested	approval · 025ec3d5	▶ view	9d2cd4d049d6...

UC-32 — and in the tamper-evident record, named rather than a UUID.

UC-33 — Know how many ways back in you have left

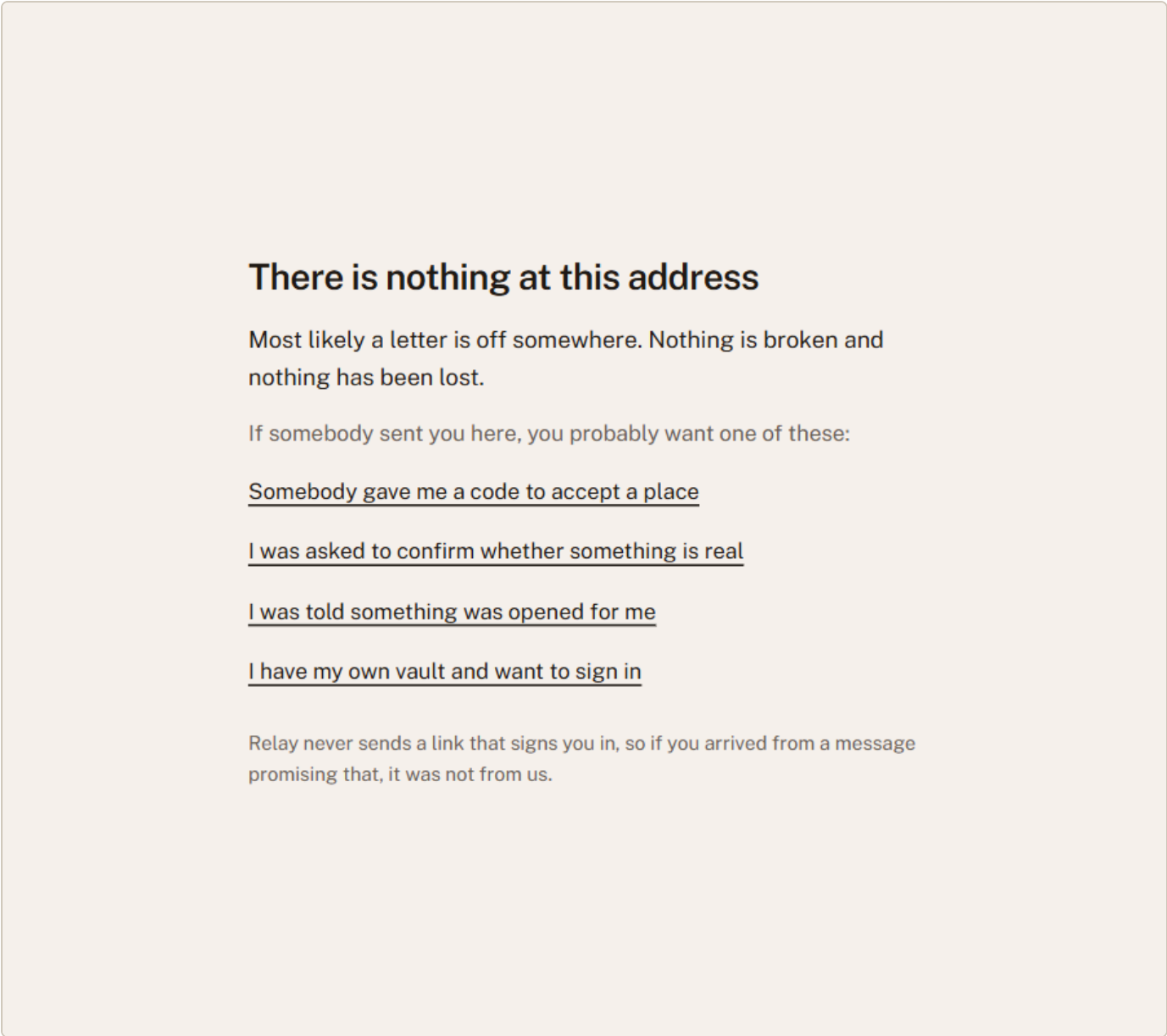
Actor	Owner
Goal	Not discover you are out of recovery codes at the moment you need one.
Expected	A count, never a code — they are stored as hashes and readable exactly once, at issue. Coloured by how much room is left, because “1 left” in the same grey as everything else is a fact nobody acts on.
Verified	Pass. Four issued with one spent read “You have 3 left.” A silent cliff until this pass: codes are consumed one per use and are the only way back when the authenticator is gone, and the product said nothing as the sheet ran down.



UC-33 — the account screen.

UC-34 — Meet a page that is missing, or one that broke

Actor	Anyone — most likely a contact who mistyped an address read to them over the phone
Goal	Not be told, in a stack-shaped default page, that something is wrong with them.
Expected	Written for the contact , not the owner: one of the two readers may be in a hospital corridor. Leads with the fear — nothing lost, nothing opened — and names the three places somebody was probably trying to reach rather than offering a dashboard they do not have.
Verified	Pass. The 404 serves the product’s voice; Next’s bare default is gone. A failure also reports itself : the digest, the path and the mode reach the operator, and the error message never does — it could carry vault content. Live-proved on production, including that a query string is stripped before it can copy a live ticket into an email.



UC-34 — an address that does not exist.

UC-35 — Judge the product without an account

Actor	Visitor, deciding whether this is worth signing up for
Goal	See what an owner sees — and what the server sees — before handing anything over.
Expected	Read-only, no account, no writes. Four stops: the vault ranked by consequence, the complete server-side record for one item, the release state machine, and the hash-chained audit trail. It must show only what a visitor can actually buy .
Verified	Pass. The chain shown in the fourth stop is computed and verified with the production primitives, so its “intact” chip is the real verifier result rather than a decoration. Two recipients under two triggers, so scoped access is shown to differ by person <i>and</i> by condition. No horizontal overflow and no undersized targets at 1280 or 390.

● **It was selling something the Terms disclaim, and this is the second time that shipped.** Four of the eight sample items routed to an `estate` trigger — excluded from `USER_SELECTABLE_TRIGGER_TYPES` pending `g2-counsel-opinion`, while `/terms` says in as many words that “Estate and inheritance functionality is not offered.” The identical contradiction had already been closed once in `/rules`, which used to render its dropdown from the unfiltered list; that fix reached the dropdown and nothing connected it to the tour.

Retargeted to a **caregiver arc** — an adult child managing a parent’s affairs, which is the wedge the product is sold on and a trigger a visitor can choose today. The same false offer appeared twice more on `/caregivers` and once in the tour’s own prose (“Estate releases, by contrast, are permanent by design”), which survived the first pass because grepping the `ITEMS` never reached the `COPY`.

Three guards now hold it: every demo item must use a selectable trigger, the prose must mention no unbuyable trigger, and the tour must keep more than one recipient and more than one trigger — so a future fix cannot quietly flatten the thing the table exists to demonstrate.

See what an owner sees.

Demo environment with fictional sample data — nothing here is a real secret, and nothing you do on this page writes anywhere.

Ranked by what matters in a crisis

ITEM	CATEGORY	IMPORTANCE	GOES TO	TRIGGER
Primary email – jordan@sample.com	Email	8.17	Sam (person)	emergency
Personnel manager master vault	Credentialed	8.16	Sam (person)	emergency
Checking & bill pay account	Banking	8.16	Sam (person)	emergency
Health & home insurance policies	Insurance	8.15	Alex (string)	string
List of instructors – care.washu.edu	Instructions	8.15	Alex (string)	string
Mortgage & deed documents	Documents	8.15	Alex (string)	string
Utilities & household subscriptions	Subscriptions	8.15	Sam (person)	emergency
Family photo archive location + key	Family photo archive location	8.15	Alex (string)	string

This is everything the server has

```

alter table
  MS-RCN-236 (set-time data key, generated in the browser)
  cipher-text
  varchar(255) binary NOT NULL,
  wrapped_data_key
  varchar(255) binary NOT NULL,
  key_id
  varchar(255) binary NOT NULL,
  meta-data
  varchar(255) binary NOT NULL,
  plain-text is not a column

stored columns: cipher-text = wrapped_data_key + key_id + meta-data = plain-text is not a column

```

One verified emergency, step by step

ARMED 3626-66-27734-62-132

Default-safe. Nothing is accessible.

The owner checks in on schedule requests hold links that resolve to armed. ARMED is the state the system falls back to whenever anything is uncertain—including when concurrent writes exhaust their retries.

```
state = "armed", version = 3
```

```
UPDATE release_state SET state='pending', version=version+1 WHERE Lo-fi AND state='armed' AND version=42
```

Grace window opens; verifiers are asked.

The owner is notified and can cancel with one check-in. Meanwhile N-of-M trusted verifiers independently confirm the emergency is real. No single person – not even a verifier – can force a release alone.

```
UPDATE release_state SET state='grace', grace_ends_at=$3 WHERE id=$1 AND state='pending' AND version=$2
```

Scoped access opens — and stays reversible.

Recipients can now decrypt only the items they were granted. When the owner recovers and checks in, the version bump instantly invalidates every recipient token and the vault re-ARMs — everything Relay offers today is reversible in exactly this way.

```
UPDATE release_state SET state='released', released_at=now() WHERE id=1 AND state='grace' AND version=52
```

Append-only, hash-chained, tamper-evident ✓ chain intact

01	new_digital_email	
TO/FW sign-in from a recognized device		0000000000_#7968e
02	valid_email_unread_count	
Item "Primary email" stored (Sophosnet + unopened key only)		0000000000_#7968e
03	kms_granted_email	
Sam granted "Primary email" under the emergency trigger		0000000000_#7968e
04	trigger_email_sent	
Emergency trigger email – 2 winners, 1 confirmation required		0000000000_#7968e
05	kms_pending_status	
Missed check-in advanced ARMED – PENDING ICAS, version 3 – 4)		0000000000_#7968e
06	kms_grace_period_control	
Grace window opened owner and verifiers notified		0000000000_#7968e
07	verifier_confirmed_certificate	
Verifier confirmation 1 of 1 received		0000000000_#7968e
08	kms_release_status	
GRACE – RELEASED ICASO recipient tokens now resolve		0000000000_#7968e
09	kms_decrypt_notification	
Recipient unopened "Primary email" via KMS [scanned batch]		0000000000_#7968e
10	kms_renewal_expired	
Owner check-in is re-armed; vault; version bump resolved all recipient tokens		0000000000_#7968e

Everything above was built for one moment in particular: the call comes, and suddenly you need their bank, their insurance portal, their email — and you need that access to end when the crisis does.

Two minutes of video shows the live system doing everything above — including a multi-region failover.

[Watch the demo video](#)
[Devpost submission](#)
[Source on GitHub](#)
[← Back to the front page](#)

UC-36 — Store more than a password, and have it open usable

Actor	Owner (storing) and recipient (opening)
Goal	An account protected by two-factor is only reachable if the person stepping in gets the second factor too — a password alone is a locked door with the key photographed.
Expected	Secret types Phase 0 (2026-08-17): the entry form takes username, password, a TOTP seed and recovery codes as separate labelled fields, encrypted in the browser as one envelope. At Reveal the recipient sees labelled fields — the password masked with Show/Copy, the TOTP seed rendered as a live six-digit code with its countdown ("type it straight after the password"), and recovery codes with a plain warning that each works once. Items imported before Phase 0 are stored as <code>{username, password}</code> permanently — the server cannot read plaintext, so no migration can rewrite them — and must decode forever.
Verified	Pass. Walked end to end on the production cluster (2026-08-17): a structured secret with a real TOTP seed stored through the browser's own crypto path, released through a genuine emergency with a verifier's counted confirmation, and revealed as labelled fields with a six-digit code equal to one computed independently from the same seed. <code>npm run verify:reveal</code> pins the whole chain — including the legacy shape — at 20/20, and runs as the fourth walk of <code>verify:live</code> .

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Nothing is in your vault yet, so there is nothing anyone could reach.

Missing: nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

Your plan cannot run yet

Send a recipient their code. Verifiers could agree, but nobody is set up to receive anything. [Go to your circle](#)

Still to set up

Your vault is empty — there is nothing to give anyone access to. [Go](#)

Nobody is named to receive access. Add the person who would step in. [Go](#)

Add item

The secret is encrypted in your browser before it is sent.

Title

e.g. Gmail

Type

login

Criticality

medium

Service name (optional)

Google

Category (optional)

—

URL (optional)

https://...

Username (optional)

The email or name you sign in with

Secret value

Password, note, or instructions – encrypted before upload

Two-factor code (optional)

otpauth://totp/... or the setup key

From your authenticator app's "can't scan the code?" text. Whoever you name will get the six digits, not this.

Recovery codes (optional)

One per line – the backup codes the service gave you

Note for your recipient (optional)

e.g. This is the account everything else resets through. Recovery codes are in the desk drawer.

Not encrypted — unlike the secret above, so never put a password or a code here. Say what the account is for, or how to get in if the password no longer works.

Save item

Cancel

UC-36 — storing: labelled fields, including the second factor, encrypted in the browser.

Your access plan

Margaret Chen chose to share these with you. Relay gives you access, not legal authority.

Work top to bottom – the most consequential items come first.

DO TODAY

1 Primary email [view](#)

[Reveal](#)

Fastmail

USERNAME[Copy](#)

margaret.chen@fastmail.test

PASSWORD[Show](#) [Copy](#)

.....

TWO-FACTOR CODE[Copy](#)

7 0 6 3 9 5

New code in 19s · type it straight after the password

RECOVERY CODES[Copy](#)

8f2k-91mz

q4rt-77bd

zz10-4kkp

N

Each of these works once. If more than one of you has access, agree who uses which.

UC-37 — Say what cannot be replaced, and leave a note

Actor	Owner
Goal	Tell the product — and the person who will step in — two things only the owner knows: which items are irreplaceable, and what a stranger to the account would need to know to use it.
Expected	Two owner overrides on every vault item (migration 034 + backup notes, 2026-08-17): “Cannot be replaced?” marks an item whose loss is permanent — a photo archive, not a streaming login — and a plain-language note travels with the item to whoever opens it. The vault’s “Worth a second look” box turns these into custody-risk advice: an irreplaceable item with no backup note is called out by name.
Verified	Pass. Both set through the product’s API against the production cluster (2026-08-17); the vault rendered the “Cannot be replaced” state and the custody-risk call-out (“This item is irreplaceable and has no backup note...”), and the note reached the recipient’s access view. ⌚ One honest caveat: the deeper three-state reachability rule (“usable / blocked / unknown” per secret kind) is written and tested but inert until migration 035 is applied — until then preparedness counts an access rule as reachability, exactly as before.

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Sign out

If something happened tomorrow, Sarah Chen could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Vault

6 items · most consequential first

Re-order by importance

Import CSV

Add item

1 Primary email

Other accounts recover through this one

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

2 Photo archive

Family photos

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

3 Checking account

First National

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Edit note

Update

Remove

4 Utilities

City Power & Water

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

5 Streaming TV

Streaming TV · <https://streaming.test>

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

6 Pharmacy refills

Pharmacy refills · <https://pharmacy.test>

Others reset through this

Cannot be replaced?

Add note

Update

Remove

Next: [name who could reach these](#) — a vault nobody can open is a vault that does nothing.

Worth a second look

Nothing here is broken and nothing is blocked — these are the items where a person stepping in would have the least to go on.

CUSTODY RISK

Photo archive — This item is irreplaceable and has no backup note — a recipient may not know where the original is kept or how to recover it.

Primary email — No plain-language note. A recipient may not understand what this account is for or how to use it.

Utilities — No plain-language note. A recipient may not understand what this account is for or how to use it.

Streaming TV — No plain-language note. A recipient may not understand what this account is for or how to use it.

Pharmacy refills — No plain-language note. A recipient may not understand what this account is for or how to use it.

UC-37 — the owner’s own knowledge, recorded where the plan can use it.

Stated coverage limits

What this document does **not** evidence, said plainly rather than left to be assumed.

SURFACE	STATUS
/import	✓ Walked 2026-08-12 — UC-28.
/start	✓ Photographed 2026-08-12 — UC-29.
A helper actually helping	✓ Built and walked 2026-08-12 — UC-24 to UC-27. Was the one journey this document could not evidence.
Policy proposals	✓ Resolved by removal 2026-08-12. policies:propose was granted to every helper, offered by nothing, and could not be applied on approval — an owner could be told a suggestion was granted and have nothing change. Dropped rather than built, because a policy joins an item to a recipient and a helper can see neither: building it honestly would mean showing them the owner's circle. An unapplicable approval can now no longer be approved at all, only rejected.
Helper import	import:run is granted and there is no helper-facing import screen. Additive once wanted.
Estate release	Withdrawn, permanently — g2-counsel-opinion was declined (2026-08-14), so the condition that would have opened estate can never be met. estate is excluded from user-selectable triggers and guards in gates.test.ts keep it, and every page's metadata, that way.